

Elements



Elements are the basic substances from which everything is made. They can be solid, liquid, or gas, and may change between these different states.



Fossils

Fossils are rocks made from the hardened remains of dead animals and plants. Footprints, burrows, and even poo can become fossilized.

Rocks and minerals

Our planet is a giant globe made from many different ingredients. The simplest of these are elements, such as iron and oxygen. If elements mix to form a solid material, it is called a mineral. When two or more different minerals are combined together, they create rock. Sometimes we dig up rocks and minerals from the ground to help us make things, or to be cut and polished into gleaming gemstones. This chapter will take you from basic elements to minerals – arranged by how hard they are – through rocks, and finally to fossils.

Rocks

Rocks are mostly made from minerals. We organise them into groups, depending on how they formed. Igneous rocks are made from cooling hot, liquid rock, often from volcanoes. Sedimentary rocks form when other pieces of rock are joined together, and metamorphic rocks are made when other rocks are heated and squeezed.



Igneous



Sedimentary



Metamorphic